

Laravel to SOC Analyst – Complete Study Guide

This document is a structured study guide for transitioning from Software Development (Laravel) into Cybersecurity with a focus on SOC (Security Operations Center) roles. It combines SOC fundamentals, SIEM usage (with Wazuh), hands-on practice, and learning resources.

1. Your Career Positioning

You have a strong advantage by combining Laravel (web application development) with SOC skills. This allows you to understand how applications are built and how attacks appear in logs, which is critical for effective threat detection and incident response.

2. SOC Roadmap Overview (90 Days)

Month 1 – SOC Foundations & SIEM Basics

- 1 SOC workflow and Tier 1 responsibilities
- 2 SIEM basics using Wazuh
- 3 Log analysis: Linux, Windows, Web, Laravel logs
- 4 MITRE ATT&CK; framework
- 5 Basic alert triage and incident summaries

Month 2 – Investigation & Detection

- 1 SIEM querying and filtering
- 2 Network traffic fundamentals
- 3 Attack simulation and detection
- 4 Incident reporting

Month 3 – Advanced SOC & Automation

- 1 Threat hunting basics
- 2 Detection engineering mindset
- 3 Python for log analysis and enrichment
- 4 SOC metrics and reporting

3. Wazuh for Month 1 SOC Training

- 1 Understand Wazuh architecture (Agent, Manager, Indexer, Dashboard)
- 2 Ingest and analyze Linux authentication logs
- 3 Monitor web server and Laravel logs
- 4 Understand alert severity and rule triggers
- 5 Map alerts to MITRE ATT&CK; techniques

4. Daily SOC Practice Routine

- 1 SIEM dashboard review and alert triage
- 2 Log analysis and investigation
- 3 MITRE ATT&CK; technique mapping
- 4 Hands-on lab or attack simulation

5. Portfolio Project (Highly Recommended)

Build a Laravel application, intentionally introduce vulnerabilities, attack it in a controlled lab environment, detect activity using Wazuh, and write a SOC-style incident report.

6. Learning Resources

SIEM & Wazuh

- 1 Wazuh Official Documentation
- 2 Wazuh YouTube Channel
- 3 Wazuh GitHub Repository

SOC & Blue Team

- 1 Blue Team Labs Online
- 2 TryHackMe – SOC & Blue Team paths
- 3 MITRE ATT&CK; Official Website

Web & Application Security

- 1 OWASP Top 10
- 2 PortSwigger Web Security Academy

Networking & Fundamentals

- 1 Cisco Networking Basics (NetAcad)
- 2 Wireshark Documentation